SCENE - 2

(***The strong room*** *at a bank, with many boxes and* ***crates*** *in it. Holmes, Watson, Jones and a policeman are on stage hiding behind some boxes.*)

Holmes : Is everything ready upstairs, Mr. Jones?

Jones : My men are waiting at the front door of the bank and near the shop.

Holmes : Good. Now we must be quiet and wait.

(*He puts out the light. The strong room is dark, but we can see the men waiting behind the crates. Nothing happens. Watson looks at his watch.*)

Watson : (*whispering*) It's 11.15, Holmes. When _____

Holmes : Sshh! Don't spoil our **investigation**.

(*They see a light coming through the stone* floor*. Suddenly the stones give way. First a hand with a gun comes out of the ground, then another hand; Spaulding comes out followed by Ross.*)

Spaulding : (*to Ross*) Now, have you got_____?

(*With his light, Holmes comes out from behind his box, and hits Spaulding's arm. Now the gun is on the ground. Ross quickly gets back into the* ***tunnel****. Jones wants to stop him, but he cannot.*)

Holmes : You can't get away, John Clay!

Spaulding : No. But Ross! My friend_____

Holmes : There are three men waiting for him at the other end.

Spaulding : You think of everything, Mr. Holmes. You're very clever.

Holmes : So are you, John Clay! Your Red-Headed League was clever!

SCENE - 3

(*Sherlock Holmes's study. Holmes and Watson are sitting on chairs.*)

Holmes : There was never any red-headed league. The villains wanted Wilson away from the shop for some hours every day. Then Clay saw the colour of Ross's hair and thought of a Red-Headed League! So when Wilson went to work in their office every day, they had time to make their tunnel. Very clever!

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